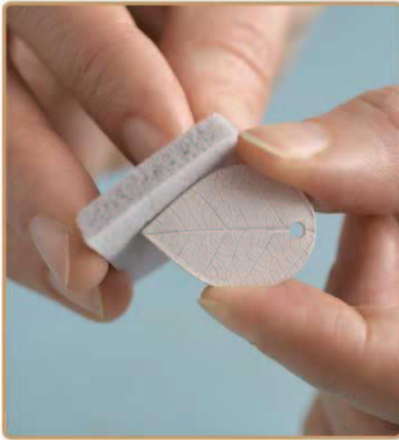




6 Leave the clay to dry overnight, or to speed up the process use a hairdryer or put the clay in an oven at 150°C (300°F/Gas mark 2) for 10 minutes. Once dry, sand it very carefully to smooth the edges.



7 Place the leaf on the firing brick or tile in a dimly lit, well-ventilated room. Hold the torch 5cm (2in) from the clay and move the flame evenly over it. The leaf will start to glow a peachy orange colour.



8 Once the leaf begins to glow, set the timer for two minutes. If the leaf turns bright red or shiny silver, it is too hot – move the flame away. Once fired, pick up the leaf with tweezers and quench it in water.



9 The leaf will now be a matt-white colour, even though it is pure silver. Gently brush it with a soft wire brush to reveal the silver colour. To achieve a high shine, rub with the back of a metal spoon.



10 Using two pairs of pliers, gently twist the ends of the jump ring away from each other. Thread it through the hole in your leaf, and then twist the jump ring closed.